

AUTOMOBILES OFFER A HUGE OPPORTUNITY



Freescale Semiconductor recently hosted its fourth technology forum in Bangalore. On the occasion, Kai Wang, vice president of sales & marketing and general manager of the Asia-Pacific region for Freescale, spoke to Jesus Milton Rousseau S. of EFY about their plans for the Indian market

■ **KAI WANG**
VICE PRESIDENT OF SALES & MARKETING AND GENERAL MANAGER OF THE ASIA-PACIFIC REGION FOR FREESCALE

What are the best selling products of Freescale in India?

In India, microprocessors are the best selling products. Freescale's 8-, 16- and 32-bit microcontrollers are used in the automotive market. Beyond microcontrollers we have networking products. Our PowerPC and PowerQUICC range of network processors are used in base stations for the networking infrastructure. These processors are also used in optical networking equipment used for Internet data transmissions. Another significant market is energy meters; we have developed a new device suited for this market.

Anything latest for India?

We have launched the LG32—a new series of 8-bit automotive microcontrollers. This product was developed by the India design centre. It is a microprocessor targeted at home appliances and automotive cluster types of applications.

Today, as more stuff goes digital, liquid-crystal display (LCD) is becoming essential. The S08LG32 MCU family is a single-chip solution that can be used for LCD along with microcontroller functions. With LCD-integrated microcontrollers, we can save our customers' cost and help them make more compact gadgets. If there is a microcontroller and an external LCD, it adds to the PCB size and the overall performance of the application. We are offering a wide variety of LCD-integrated microcontrollers. The LL family is another new product for low-end LCD applications.

How do you rate India compared to other countries in the APAC region?

Financial crisis worldwide has hit the market mostly in the US and Europe but Asia is a growth engine. In India and China, still there is demand. The four major market areas in Asia are networking, industrial, consumer and automotive.

In India, the pace of growth is fast but the volume is lower than China. Taiwan, Korea and Singapore have shown a steady but average growth. India is strong in software and

R&D support. We have more than 1000 people engaged in R&D in India. We also support global customers who have R&D centres in India.

Which market offers the highest potential—automotive, consumer, industrial, networking or wireless?

The automotive market offers a huge opportunity. There will be more electronics embedded in two- and four-wheelers. In two-wheelers, for instance, Bajaj Pulsar uses Freescale MCUs for body electronics, cluster and ignition control.

Next comes the industrial segment, which includes energy meters, UPS, inverters and LED lighting. Third is networking and telecom. Also emerging are analogue and consumer markets, which we would like to focus on.

Your future plans for the Indian market?

India is a very important market for us. We have three design centres in India, in Bangalore, Hyderabad and Noida. We will continue to support our transnational customers worldwide from India. We will support global design services and product delivery in India; and since India is a growing economy we will focus on local customers in networking, energy, industrial and automotive sectors.

Are you affected by the global recession? If yes, what measures have you taken?

Our customers are affected and so it will indirectly affect us. We are focussing on our strengths in networking, industrial, consumer and automotive sectors. We are going to exit the mobile baseband market and focus on products like analogue drivers, to maintain leadership in the radio-frequency (RF) market.

While it is a challenge, we are focused on new designs, new projects and new opportunities. We are working in different ways. In India, energy-saving LED lighting, for instance, has shown tremendous growth. So we are looking at opportunities where there is growth and focusing on our strengths. ●